

MB 509: Introduction to Bhagavad Gita

Course Code: MB 509

Course Name: Introduction to Bhagavad Gita

L-T-P-C: 2-0-0-2

Prerequisites: NA

Intended for: MBA

Mutual Exclusion: NA

Approval: 55th BoA; revised in 60th BoA (text books revised)

Preamble

Bhagavad Gita explores at length the five major branches of knowledge such as Individual conscious entity, Supreme conscious entity, Material nature, Time, and Actions. It also contains enriching discussion between Arjuna and Krishna on topics such as dilemmas of life, identity conflict, theory of actions (forbidden action, recommended action, Inactions), importance of controlled mind, qualities that builds a divine personality, bondage and freedom, etc. It is considered as a manual of life which outlines essential principles of leading a fulfilling life. Off late, it has garnered ample attention from management scholars and volumes of scholarly literature in form of journals papers, books, and conference proceedings are published on this subject. It is, therefore, pertinent for the aspiring managers and business leaders to understand the principles of Bhagavad Gita to aid them in decision making. This course is an earnest attempt to make the students aware of the time tested principles of Bhagavad Gita which will help them deal with adversaries of life and equip them with better decision making power in the interest of themselves, organization, community, society, and other important stakeholders.

Course Modules

- **Unit/Topic 1:** Bhagavad Gita: The timeless science (2 Hours)
- **Unit/Topic 2:** Krishna: As He is (2 Hours)
- **Unit/Topic 3:** Description of atomic soul (3 Hours)
- **Unit/Topic 4:** Matter and consciousness (3 Hours)
- **Unit/Topic 5:** Yoga systems (2 Hours)
- **Unit/Topic 6:** Transcendental knowledge (2 Hours)
- **Unit/Topic 7:** Mindfulness from Bhagavad Gita (3 Hours)
- **Unit/Topic 8:** The topmost yoga system (2 Hours)
- **Unit/Topic 9:** Modes of material nature and professional excellence (3 hours)
- **Unit/Topic 10:** Perfection of renunciation (2 hours)

Laboratory/Practical/Tutorial Modules

NA

Text Books

1. Prabhupada, ACBS, *Bhagavad Gita: As it is*, Bhaktivedanta Book Trust, Mumbai, 1972.
2. L. Behera., *Five Aspects of the Absolute Truth - a Bhagavad Gita Study Guide*, India, 2022.
3. L. Behera, *Bhagavad Gita Study Guide Part I: Karma Yoga*.

References

1. Chatterjee, D. (2012). *Timeless leadership: 18 leadership sutras from the Bhagavad Gita*. John Wiley & Sons.
2. Nayak, A. K. (2018). Effective leadership traits from Bhagavad Gita. *International Journal of Indian Culture and Business Management*, 16(1), 1-18.
3. Krishnan, R., Jain, R., & Maheshwari, A. K. (2023). Development of Consciousness-Based Leadership from Bhagavad Gita and Yoga Sutras. In *Consciousness-Based Leadership and Management, Volume 2: Organizational and Cultural Approaches to Oneness and Flourishing* (pp. 97-113). Cham: Springer International Publishing.